

THE MECHA



A Mechanical Engineering Newsletter of Sorts.

WANT MORE MECH INFO? VISIT CLUBMECH.SITES.OLT.UBC.CA | FACEBOOK: MECHANICAL ENGINEERING | NOV 30TH, 2015

Upcoming Events

Keep an eye out for more info on these events!

Christmas Party	Dec 3 (12 – 1:30pm)
14 Not Forgotten	Dec 3 (12:30 at the EDC)
BEvERage Giveaway	Dec 4 (last day of classes!)
EUS Christmas Caroling	Dec 4 (7am at the ESC)

Congrats to the MECH team for winning the EUS Flag Football tournament last week!

Engineering Numbers

Number of weeks left in this semester: **1**
(THIS WEEK!)

Number of weeks in the exam period: **≤2**
(December 8 – 22)

Number of exams scheduled within a 24-hour period deemed cruel and unusual: **>2**
(This is called “examination hardship”, and you may request a schedule change to make it less brutal)

Conversations in Club Mech: A Play (on words) In Three Parts

Act 1: Dam Civil!

“Our current mecha prof had so much energy when he was torquing about the Mech-Civil rivalry today, eh?”

“It almost hertz how amped up he was – I really don’t know what’s going on there.”

“I’m taking a civil timber course this semester; you would be board stiff in it. It’s like an abusive relationship: I’m under a lot of stress and about to buckle, but I cantilever. Because I need the credits.”

“Beeching about it like that is just aspen for trouble, you know.”

“Whatever man, you wouldn’t be much better at bearing the load if it were you!”

Act 2: Winging it

“Dude I’ll help you land a girl if you give me a drive to the party.”

“No way – one airplane design course doesn’t qualify you as a wingman.”

“Well with an altitude like that... Come on, I’ll talk to the ladies, then you say yaw pitch, and they’ll be ready for a roll in the—

“Hey, I don’t want to be a drag, but not so fast, please!”

“Oh quit stalling. Half the time you’re droning on about boeing single, but now that you might meet a girl you’re just going to be idle?”

“I don’t need your help to venturi out and wind dates. It’s just that I’m a backer of old fashioned romance.”

“Uh huh, you’re just afraid you’ll crash and burn. What a yoke!”

Act 3: Work Anec-don’ts

“One time at my co-op job last semester, we had these easily-excitable customer. I showed him a design my boss had done, and he went crazy, shouting “why did you put the engine over there?! I told you it goes right here!” Eventually he ran out of steam, and stomped out saying, “I’m going to come back tomorrow, and when I do, I want to see the...”

person who engineered this.”

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Can you solve the puzzle? If you think you’ve figured it out, post your solution as a comment under this newsletter’s posting at clubmech.sites.olt.ubc.ca/. **The first person to post the correct answer will receive a prize!**

Kipling, and The Sons of Martha

Hang on – biblical stuff and some old writer? What place do these things have in a Mechanical Engineering newsletter? Well, besides winning a Nobel Prize in literature and being the author of *The Jungle Book*, Kipling is responsible for the bulk of “The Ritual of the Calling of an Engineer”. This is the ceremony where you’ll receive your iron ring, which will mark you as a Canadian Engineer and henceforth remind you of your obligations to society.

Kipling had quite the relationship with religion – he rejected Christianity in his youth but eventually from his writings some believe that he came to treat Allah and God interchangeably as representations of his belief of a strong and fallible higher power. My favorite of his engineering-related works is a poem based on a bible story in Christ visits Martha and Mary, and Martha gets told off for taking charge of the chores associated with tending to a visitor instead of sitting and listening to Christ speak as Mary does. The poem is about us: the engineers, the workers and the builders, and how we take care of humanity’s physical needs. Some excerpts:

“It is their care in all the ages to take the buffet and cushion the shock.
It is their care that the gear engages; it is their care that the switches lock.
It is their care that the wheels run truly; it is their care to embark and entrain,
Tally, transport, and deliver duly the Sons of Mary by land and main.

They do not preach that their God will rouse them a little before the nuts work loose.
They do not preach that His Pity allows them to drop their job when they damn-well choose.
As in the thronged and the lighted ways, so in the dark and the desert the stand,
Wary and watchful all their days that their brethren’s ways may be long in the land.”

Belief systems aside, I hope you’ll take the meat of his message and wear the Engineer title with pride.

This Too Shall Pass

This was the message hidden in the piece of music in last month’s edition of the Mecha, written in Morse code. (Fun fact: before “SOS” became the standard distress call in 1908, the code “SQD” was used. Anyone at the UBC Amateur Radio Society could tell you why it was those letters if you drop by their headquarters in the old old sub and ask, which you absolutely should! Check them out at <http://ars.ams.ubc.ca/> and consider becoming a ham radio license holder!). Anything worth one beat (quarter notes and tied eighth notes) were dots, and anything worth half a beat (quarter notes without a tie) were dashes; the spaces broke up letters and words. The writing it’s set to is just a small sample of one of the beautiful works the poet Rumi has created.

This is my favorite quote – it’s gotten me through some rough times and helped me to savour the good ones. Wikipedia tells me that this adage likely came from a fable by a Persian Sufi poet. It has since been used in a speech by Abraham Lincoln, and scrawled on the quote walls of numerous hostels and summer camps.

When you find yourself wavering as you slog through the barrage of assignments, reports, tests, and problem sets, remember that it will pass. You won’t be in school forever! The exam blues will pass (and hopefully so will you!). The relationship woes will pass. The job search worries will pass. The time will inevitably plod along, and soon you’ll be enjoying Christmas break. That, too, will pass, so I hope you’ll be present for the festivities, and that you cherish and store those memories.

If you find yourself using this mantra to get through depression – due to school life, home life, seasons, or whatever, give the UBC Counselling Services a call, at (604) 822 3811 to set up an appointment – they don’t do drop-ins without an appointment. If you’re hesitant to do that, because you’re shy or you don’t think your troubles are important enough, or you just don’t know how to get started, or whatever, please come talk to me (Marianne Kobierski, your humble Mecha editor!) and we can chat over coffee.